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May 26-29, 2026
Pre-Conference: May 25-26, 2026

celebrating 60 years air

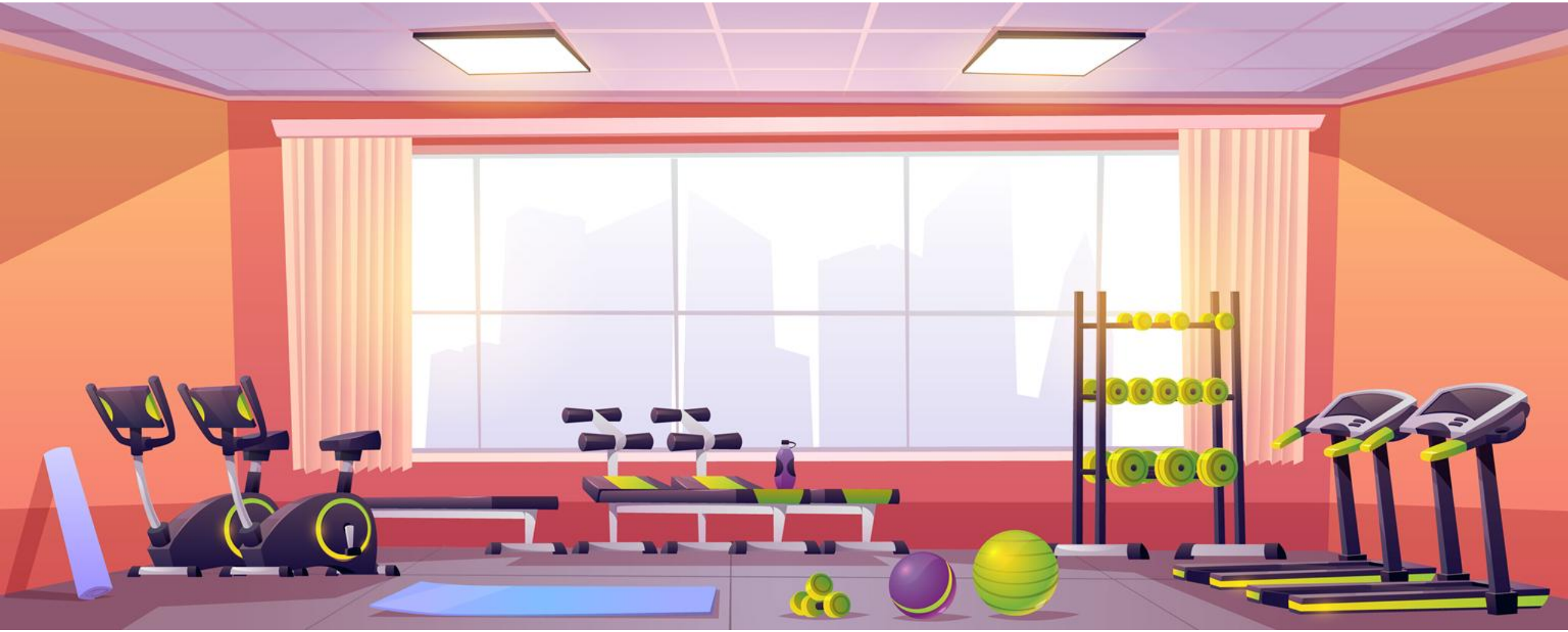
Measuring Dashboard Utilization to Improve Decision-Making



Andrew Sommer



Lakshmi Ponnurasan



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Dashboards are a lot like gym memberships.

Institutions invest in them.

People get access.

Everyone uses it for a while...
and then...

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Measuring Dashboard Utilization to Improve Decision-Making



Andrew Sommer



Lakshmi Ponnurasan

Andrew Sommer

Turning Data into Decisions



Chief Data Officer | Missouri S&T

Microsoft Certifications



Let's Connect!

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Hi, It's me!



Power BI DataViz 2025 & 2026

WORLD CHAMPIONSHIP FINALIST

Microsoft CERTIFIED POWER BI DATA ANALYST ASSOCIATE

MVP Microsoft® Most Valuable Professional

MISSOURI S&T

Data Analyst - Institutional Effectiveness







DIVERSITY &INCLUSION

Santhana Lakshmi Ponnurasan

Game Plan

01 The Challenge We Faced

02 The Impact on Decision-Making

03 Our Solution

04 What We Did in Practice?

05 Showcase

06 Key Takeaways

07 Your Next Steps



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The Challenge We Faced

Dashboards Built but Not Used

Great dashboards lose their value when they sit unused.

If no one uses it,
it delivers no impact.



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The Impact

Wasted Time & Money

Resources spent building and maintaining dashboards that don't deliver value.

Lost Productivity

Teams spend extra time creating, updating, and explaining reports no one uses.

Poor Decision-Making

Outdated or unused data leads to gaps, guesses, and missed opportunities.



Low User Confidence

If dashboards are hard to use or irrelevant, trust in data declines.

Information Overload

Too many dashboards create clutter, making it harder to find what matters.

Strategic Blind Spots

Critical insights remain hidden, limiting impact and accountability.

An unused dashboard is more than an inconvenience—
it's a missed opportunity to drive better outcomes.

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Our Solution

Measure Dashboard Utilization

A beautifully built dashboard that no one uses delivers **zero value.**

Without measuring engagement, institutions cannot distinguish between tools that **drive decisions** and those that **simply exist.**



Measure utilization.
Maximize impact.
Drive better decisions.

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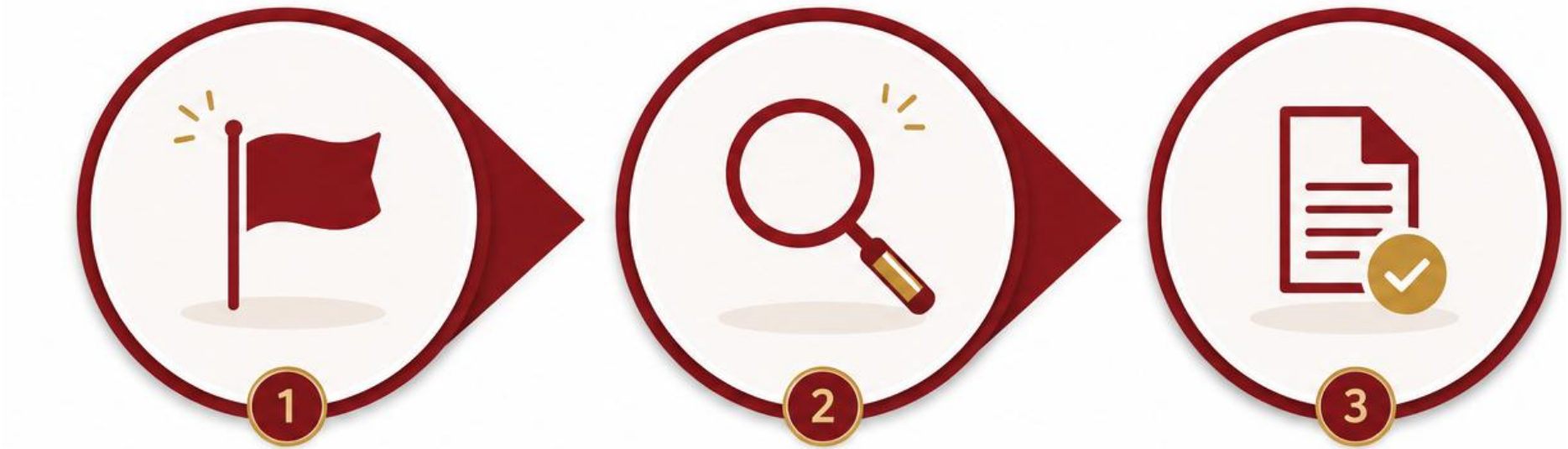
What We Did in Practice?


1
Flag
Identify dashboards with
low usage or outdated value.

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1
Flag
Identify dashboards with low usage or outdated value.
2
Investigate
Understand usage, audience, relevance, and impact.

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1
Flag
Identify dashboards with low usage or outdated value.
2
Investigate
Understand usage, audience, relevance, and impact.
3
Decide
Optimize, retire, or invest based on findings.

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Flag

Identifying Underused/ Unused Dashboards

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Identifying Underused/ Unused Dashboards



Zero or Near-Zero Traffic

Dashboards with no visits in 90+ days are candidates for retirement or redesign.

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Identifying Underused/ Unused Dashboards

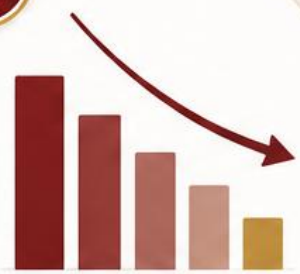
1



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Dashboards with no visits in 90+ days are candidates for retirement or redesign.

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Declining Trend

A steady drop in engagement signals waning value or a change in user needs.

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Identifying Underused/ Unused Dashboards

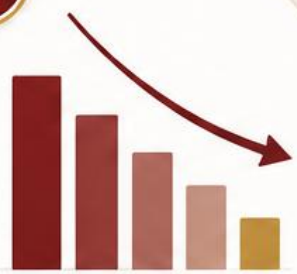
1



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3



Wrong Audience Access

Usage concentrated outside the intended user group indicates a discovery or targeting problem.

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Investigate

Common Patterns that we observed

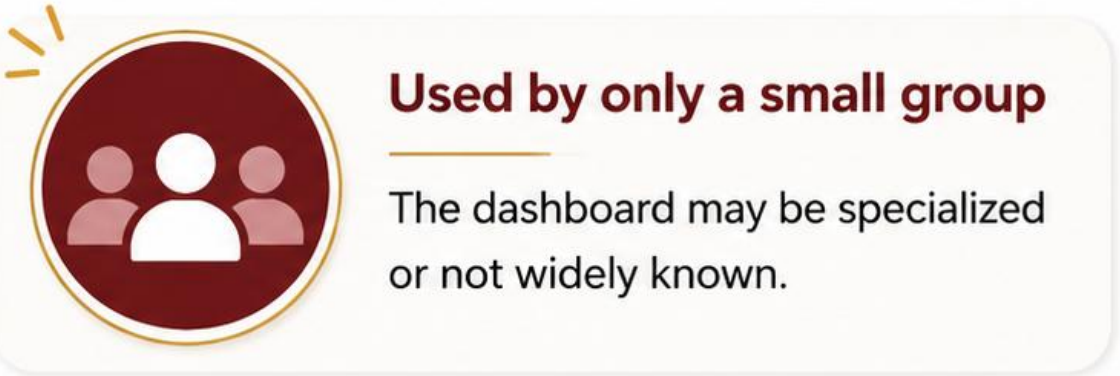


Common Patterns that we observed



Declining usage over time

The dashboard may no longer meet current needs or priorities.



Used by only a small group

The dashboard may be specialized or not widely known.

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Sudden spikes in usage

A reporting deadline or key decision period is driving demand.



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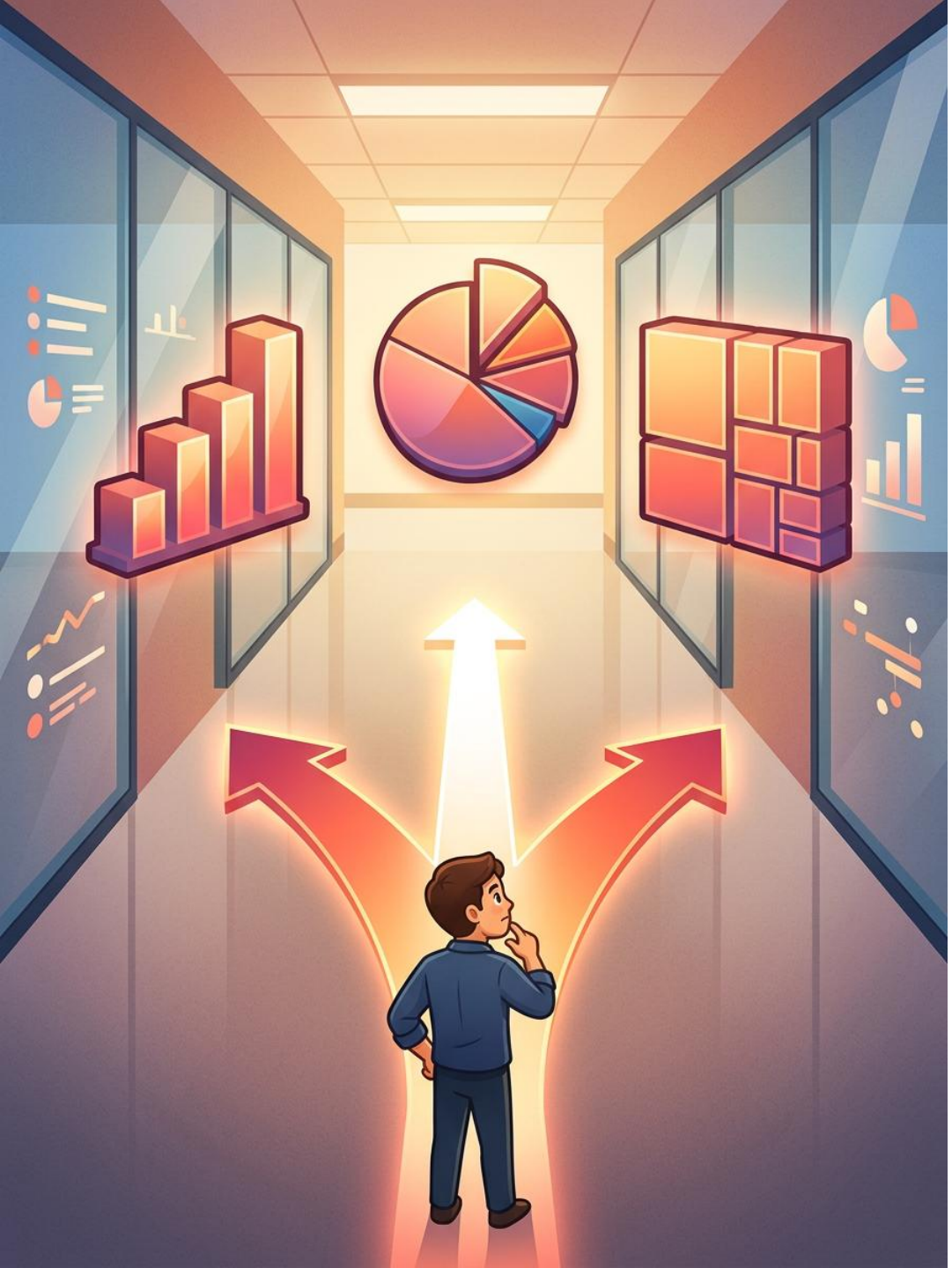
The dashboard may be specialized or not widely known.



Some dashboards/reports rarely or never opened

Not all content is equally useful or visible.

Decide



Three Targeted Actions

- **Refine**
- **Promote**
- **Retire**

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The 3 Targeted Actions



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The 3 Targeted Actions

1 Refine: Improve What Exists



Improve the layout

Organize visuals to guide attention and reduce confusion.



Simplify Visuals

Remove unnecessary elements and focus on what matters most.



Update Content

Ensure metrics and definitions reflect current priorities.

2 Promote: Drive Adoption



Structured Onboarding & Training

Embed dashboard training into induction for new staff and leaders. Help users build confidence in interpreting the data.



Share with stakeholders

Actively communicate where and how dashboards add value. Share insights and use cases via newsletters or leadership briefings.



Add to workflows

Embed dashboards into routine meetings and decisions.

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3 Retire: Let Go Gracefully



Confirm zero usage or if outdated

Validate with data over a sustained period. Eliminate reports that no longer support active decisions.



Check dependencies

Ensure no downstream reports rely on it.

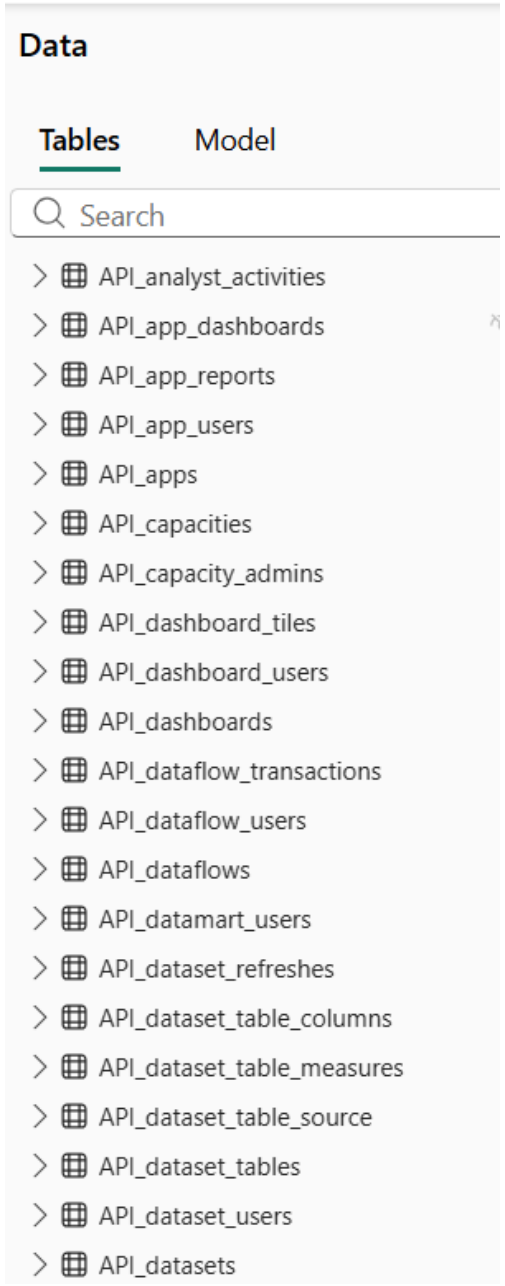


Archive, don't delete

Preserve for audit or historical reference.

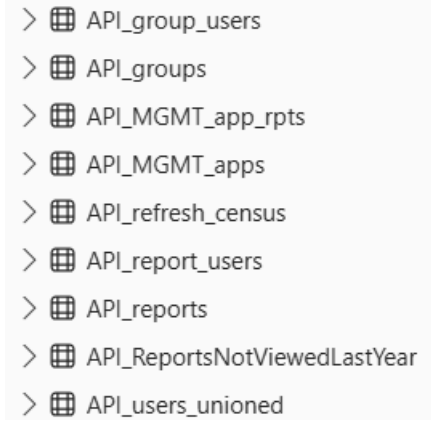
Showcase

Backend



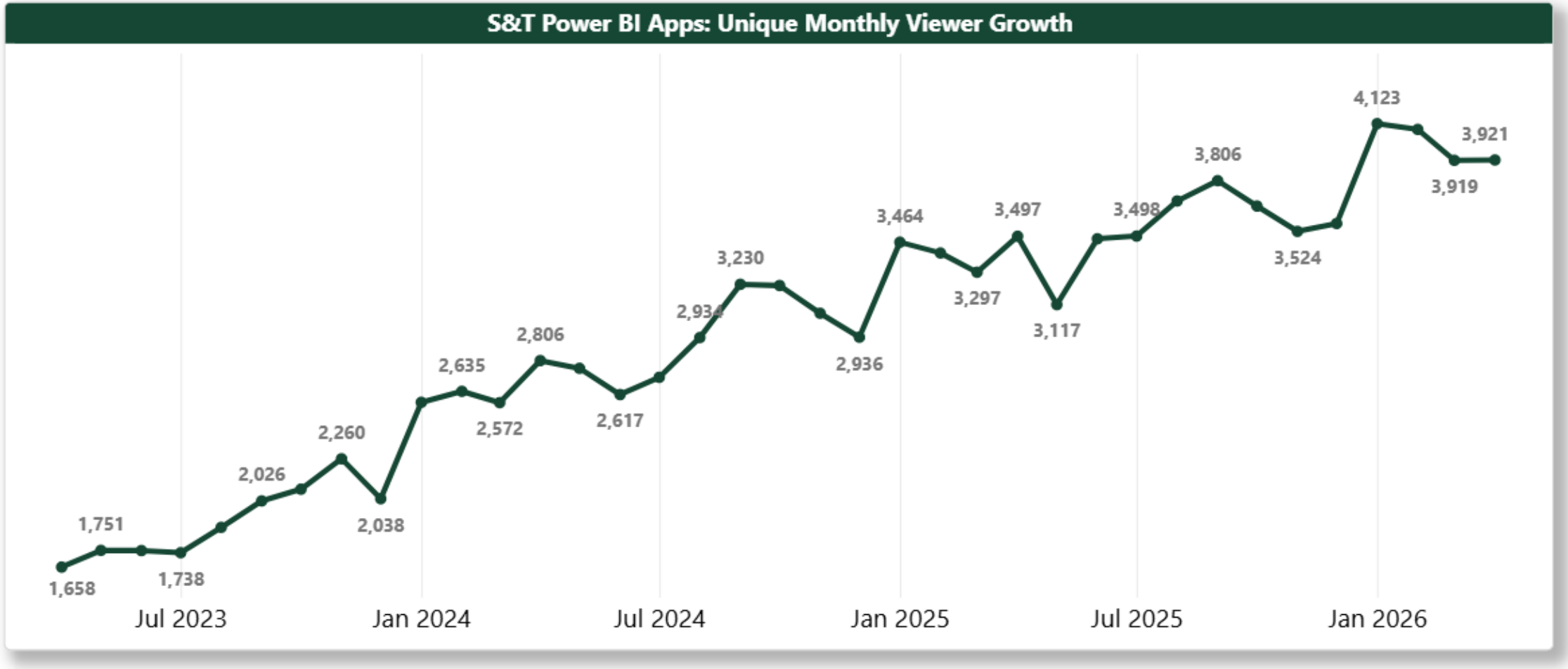
Microsoft Fabric REST API:
https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/rest/api/fabric/articles/

https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/fabric/admin/operation-list



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Actual Stats



Power BI Report Demo

Usage Stats as of 05/29/2026

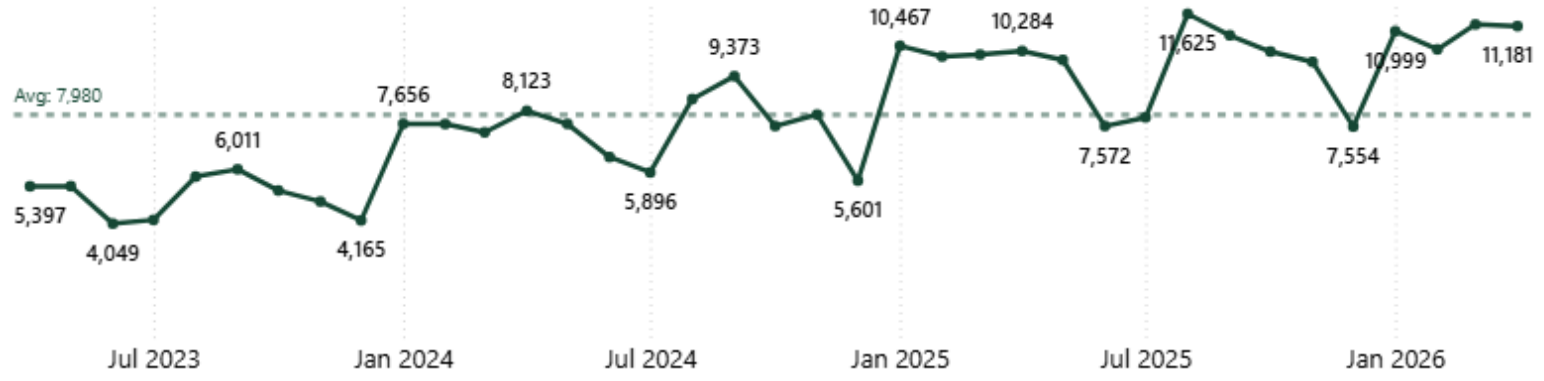
2023 | 2024 | 2025 | 2026

View Count
295,254
Views Past 180 Days 43,765

Users
250
Avg Views Per User 1181

Apps
17
Reports 89

Total View Count Trend



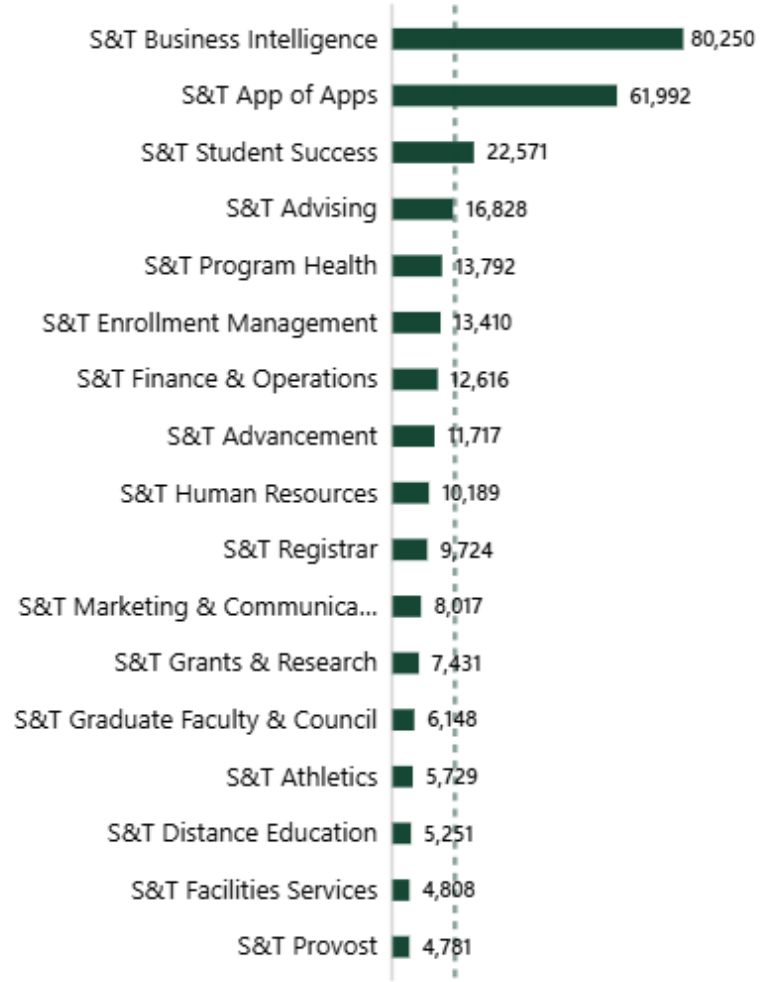
Unique View Count Trend



Total Views by App

Right click to view User Stats

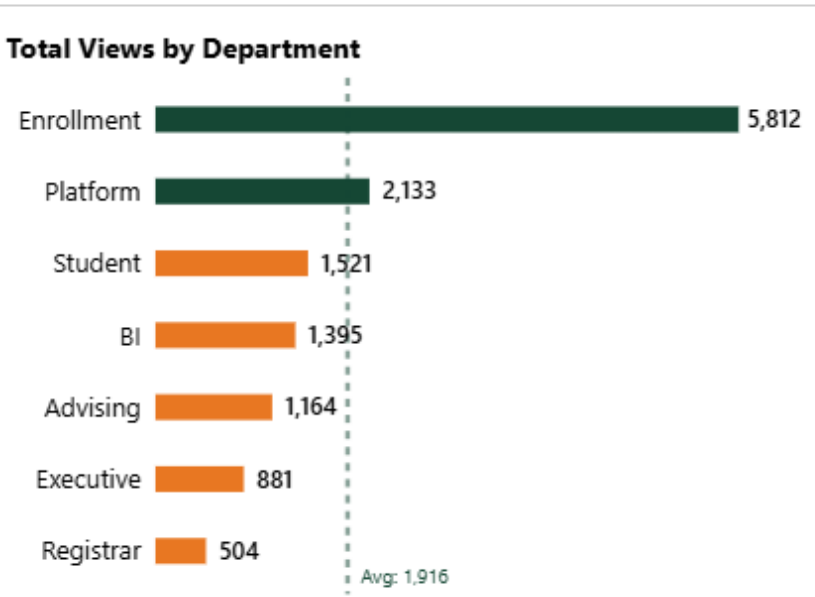
Total Views | Unique Views

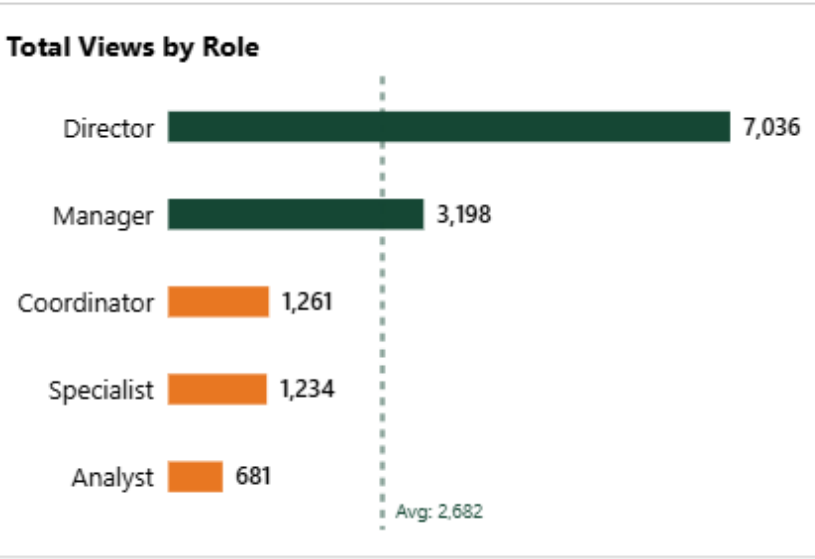


Click For Report Stats

User Stats of S&T Enrollment Management

Viewer Name	Department	Role	Report Breadth	Total Views	Views Per User	Last Seen
Andrew Hayes	Registrar	Director	6	265	265	May 7, 2026
Andrew Long	Enrollment	Director	6	452	452	May 7, 2026
Aria Hayes	Executive	Manager	6	79	79	May 7, 2026
Aria Long	Enrollment	Director	6	626	626	May 7, 2026
Ava Rivera	Platform	Manager	6	591	591	May 7, 2026
Benjamin Brooks	Executive	Specialist	6	63	63	May 7, 2026
Chloe Bell	Platform	Manager	6	152	152	May 7, 2026
Chloe Richardson	BI	Analyst	6	322	322	May 7, 2026
Chloe Thompson	Enrollment	Director	6	607	607	May 7, 2026
Claire Murphy	Enrollment	Specialist	6	561	561	May 7, 2026
Dakota Kent	Executive	Director	1	15	15	February 24, 2026
Dakota Owen	Registrar	Specialist	1	4	4	February 24, 2026
Daniel Bailey	Enrollment	Director	6	173	173	May 7, 2026
Daniel Hayes	Enrollment	Coordinator	6	119	119	May 7, 2026
David Hayes	Enrollment	Analyst	1	30	30	February 26, 2026
Ella Long	Advising	Director	6	552	552	May 7, 2026
Ethan Brooks	Enrollment	Manager	6	155	155	May 7, 2026
Ethan Brooks	Platform	Director	6	397	397	May 7, 2026
Evelyn Thompson	BI	Analyst	6	300	300	May 7, 2026
Grace Kelly	Enrollment	Director	6	434	434	May 7, 2026



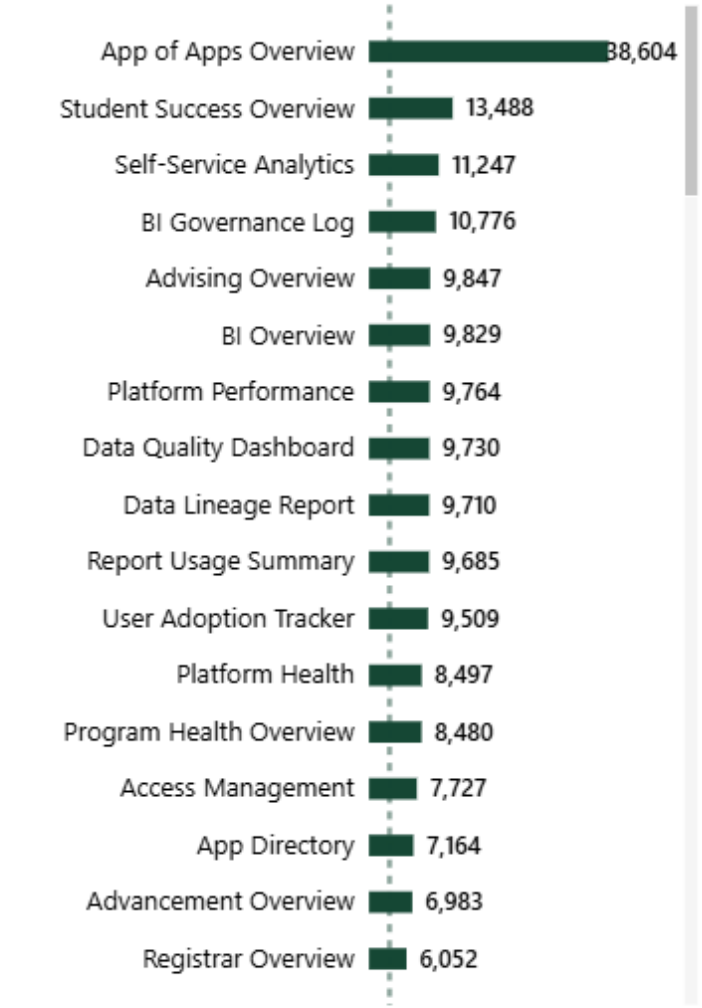


Report Stats as of 05/29/2026

App Name: All

Total Views | Unique Views

Total Views by Report Name



AppName	Total Views	Unique Views	Engagement Rate	Views Per User	Latest View Date
S&T Provost					
Departmental Benchmarks	257	13	81.25%	16	October 20, 2025
Academic Affairs Summary	271	12	92.31%	21	September 12, 2025
Provost KPIs	307	12	100.00%	26	November 27, 2025
Faculty Productivity Report	325	12	80.00%	22	November 7, 2025
Strategic Initiatives Tracker	334	12	92.31%	26	December 3, 2025
Accreditation Dashboard	354	12	92.31%	27	September 18, 2025
Provost Overview	2,933	21	95.45%	133	April 26, 2026
S&T Facilities Services					
Work Order Summary	1,052	15	88.24%	62	December 29, 2025
Facilities Overview	1,223	13	86.67%	82	November 2, 2025
Space Utilization	1,256	14	77.78%	70	December 2, 2025
Maintenance Tracker	1,277	16	94.12%	75	November 16, 2025
S&T Distance Education					
Online Enrollment Trends	903	16	84.21%	48	November 19, 2025
Course Completion Rates	1,005	15	93.75%	63	October 19, 2025
Distance Ed Overview	1,049	17	89.47%	55	October 22, 2025
Modality Comparison	1,066	14	87.50%	67	November 18, 2025

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Attrition Probability

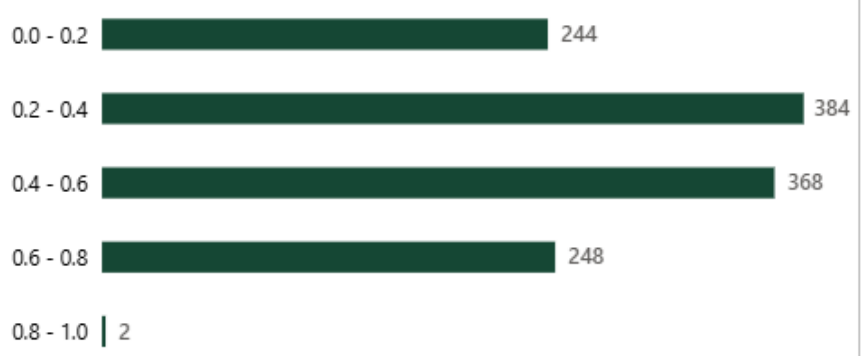
For Current Term

Avg Attrition Prob Score	Students at Risk #	Withdrew This Term #
0.40	618	55
Prior 0.41 (0.00 | 0.5% ▼)	Prior 610 (8 | 1.3% ▲)	Prior 80 (25 | 31.3% ▼)

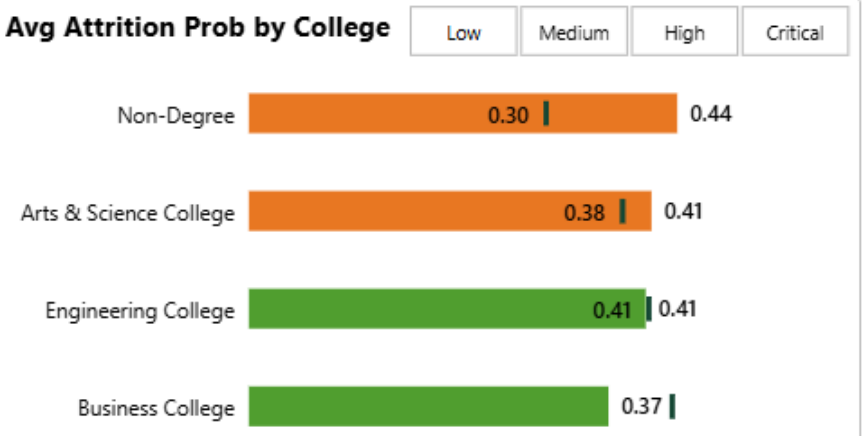
Right click to drill-through

Advisor Name	Risk Low #	Risk Medium #	Risk High #	Risk Critical #
Asbury,Nyhlamarie	14	15	14	17
Meyers,Carl	19	12	18	17
Flentje,Linda	18	15	23	15
Long,Erica Lea	15	15	21	15
Bassett,Kaleb Colt	8	18	23	14
Cottrell,Norma-Gene	11	20	20	14
Hite,Tessa Corrinne	12	19	17	14
Lim,Chaw Koon Desiree	9	16	9	14
Runnion,Jennifer	10	27	19	14
Glidden,Tyler James	5	21	21	12
McCain,Jade Sierra	9	17	16	12
Patel,Sunita	11	23	20	11
Seely,Jody Kimberly	13	18	12	11
Sertell,Jill Kathryn	9	15	16	11
Williams,Derek Ray	10	13	24	11
McMillen,Amy Louise	8	16	19	10
Arthur,Donna	15	21	16	9
Torres,Miguel	9	18	12	9
Casey,Stephen Christopher	13	24	17	7
North,Mallory Gail	11	15	16	7

Students # by Avg Attrition Prob Range



Avg Attrition Prob by College



College/Acad_Plan	Students	Avg Attrition Prob	# Top Quintile	% Top Quintile
⊟ Non-Degree	7	0.44	2	28.57%
NON-DEG	4	0.50	2	50.00%
AUDIT	3	0.35	0	0.00%
⊟ Arts & Science College	127	0.41	26	20.47%
PHYSIC-BS	8	0.61	3	37.50%
BIO SC-BS	11	0.48	5	45.45%
PSYCH-BA	10	0.44	3	30.00%
PSYCH-BS	6	0.41	2	33.33%
MULTI-BA	16	0.41	3	18.75%
EDUC-BS	13	0.40	2	15.38%
CHEM-BA	7	0.40	1	14.29%
HIST-BA	10	0.40	2	20.00%
AP MATH-BS	9	0.40	1	11.11%
CHEM-BS	7	0.39	1	14.29%
HIST-BS	12	0.36	1	8.33%
ENGL TC-BS	7	0.35	1	14.29%
BIO SC-BA	6	0.33	1	16.67%
ENV SCI-BS	5	0.29	0	0.00%
⊟ Engineering College	1054	0.41	212	20.11%
UN-ENG-UN	61	0.43	15	24.59%
CMP SC-BS	56	0.43	15	26.79%
GL&GPH-BS	53	0.43	12	22.64%
NU ENG-BS	59	0.43	14	23.73%
AE ENG-BS	58	0.42	11	18.97%
MI ENG-BS	57	0.42	12	21.05%
CR ENG-BS	66	0.42	12	18.18%
EL ENG-BS	62	0.41	16	25.81%
CP ENG-BS	53	0.41	13	24.53%
MT ENG-BS	67	0.41	10	14.93%
Total	1246	0.40	250	20.06%

Key Takeaways

KEY TAKEAWAYS



Measure what matters

Track engagement metrics that reflect genuine decision-making use, not just access counts.

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Act on the evidence

Use usage patterns to refine, retire, or promote dashboards with confidence.

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Act on the evidence

Use usage patterns to refine, retire, or promote dashboards with confidence.



Design for adoption

Purpose-driven, timely, and actionable dashboards earn repeat visits and institutional trust.

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And how to design for **adoption**?

And how to design for adoption?



And how to design for adoption?



And how to design for adoption?



Co-design with end users from the outset

Involve the right people early to ensure the dashboard solves real problems.



Use plain language, not technical jargon

Make insights easy to understand for all users, regardless of role or expertise.



Provide context- benchmarks, trends, targets

Help users interpret the ‘why’ behind the numbers and make informed decisions.

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Test prototypes before full deployment

Gather feedback, iterate, and refine to ensure the dashboard delivers value.

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Your Next Steps

NEXT STEPS

A simple path to a smarter, more valuable dashboard portfolio.



Audit your Current Portfolio

Take inventory of all dashboards, their owners, audiences, and current usage.

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Define your Core Metrics

Agree on key usage and value metrics that indicate success or decline.

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Build a Feedback Loop

Continuously gather user input and usage data to drive ongoing improvement.

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THANK YOU!

Don’t forget to rate our session and leave your feedback!







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Q&A